

9 Invitations and notifications

Facebook allows your application user to invite his friends to use that application, which acts like viral marketing in spreading your application. So, as an application developer, you should determine when and how to let them invite their friends and how to make your application a sure success so that the friends of your application user also pay a visit to your application. You can also let their user send email notifications. Let's get started on creating a successful invitation and notification system for your application, something which uses these constructs efficiently and help your application spread.

9.1 Invitations

Invitations are used to send emails to friends of a user of that application in Facebook applications, using which, any one of his or her friends can subscribe to your Facebook application. This is a great way of promoting your application.

Until sometime back, users of your application could to send invitations to all their friends at a time, but recently Facebook added some strict policies such as, a user can invite only 20 of his/her friends each day and so you have to design the whole system using Facebook API, or the default widget provided. An invitation system on Facebook has several parts. The FBML tags used to create an Invitation system are:

- `fb:request-form`
- `fb:req-choice`
- `fb:request-form-submit`
- `fb:application-name`
- `fb:multi-friend-input`
- `fb:friend-selector`
- `fb:multi-friend-selector(condensed)`

However, you cannot change the default look and feel of this one unless you use CSS style sheets.

9.1.1 `fb:request-form`

This tag acts as the primary widget for inviting friends A typical invitation code will look like:

```
<fb:request-form
```